5. Villages and
6. Panchayats

Most district in India are divided into two or more subdivision, each incharge of an Assistant Collector or Sub Collector. Each division is again divided into taluks, incharge of a Thasildhar. A taluk usually comprises between 200 to 600 villages. The community development block comprises approximately 100 villages and about 80000 to 1,20,000 population, in charge of a Block Development Officer. Finally, there are the village panchayats which are institutions of rural local self-government.

The urban areas of the district are organized into the following institutions of local self-government:

1. Town Area Committees (in areas with population ranging between 5,000 to 10,000)
2. Municipal Boards (in areas with population ranging between 10,000 and 2,00,000)
3. Corporations (with population above 2,00,000)

The Town Area Committees are like panchayats. They provide sanitary services. The Municipal Boards are headed by Chairman / President, elected by members.

The functions of Municipal Board & Corporations

1. Construction and maintenance of roads
2. Sanitation and drainage
3. Street lighting
4. Water supply
5. Maintenance of hospitals and dispensaries
6. Education and
7. Registration of births and deaths etc.

The Corporations are headed by Mayors, elected by councillors, who are elected from different wards of the city. The executive agency includes the commissioner, the secretary, the engineer and the health officer.

The activities are similar to those of municipalities on a much wider scale.

2.2.4 Panchayat Raj

The Panchayat Raj is a 3-tier structure of rural local self-government in India linking the village to the district

The three institutions are:

1) Panchayat (at the village level)
2) Panchayat Samiti (at the block level)
3) Zila Parishad (at the district level)

1) Panchayat (at the village level)

The Panchayat Raj at the village level consists of

- The Gram Sabha
- The Gram Panchayat
- The Nyaya panchayat

The Gram Sabha considers proposals for taxation and elects members of the gram panchayat.

The Gram Panchayat covers the civic administration including sanitation and public health and work for the social and economic development of the village.

2) Panchayat Samiti (at the block level):

The Panchayat Samiti execute the community development programme in

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